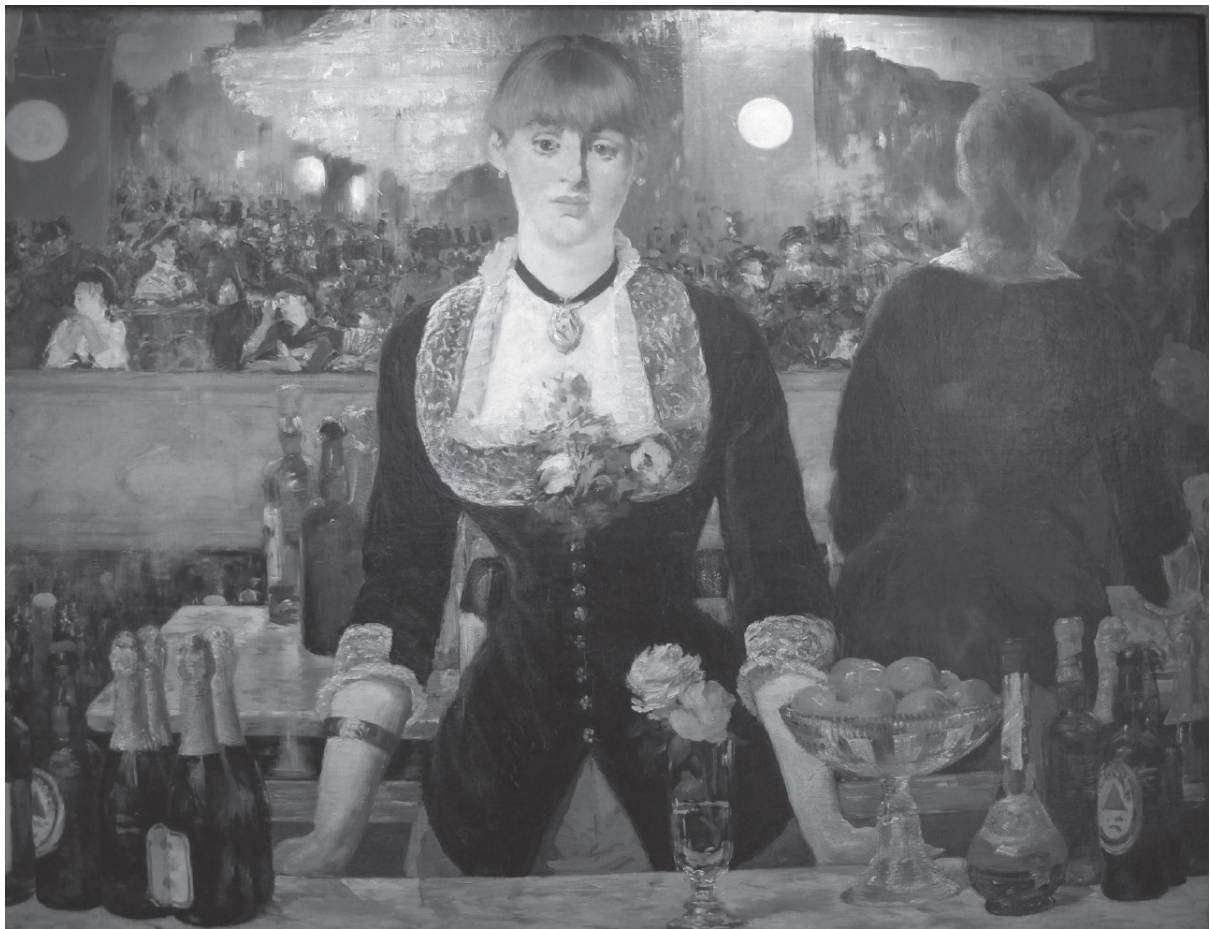


Manet

One of the first 19th-century artists to paint modern life, Édouard Manet (1833–82) was integral in the transition from Realism to Impressionism. With his absence of half tones, flattening of forms, restricted palette, bold brushwork and irreverent subject matter that disregarded the conventions of Academic art, he painted contemporary life and impressions of passing moments. Perceived as shocking at the time, these ideas later became crucial elements in Impressionism and Manet's influence continued in many subsequent movements.

Greatly influenced by Velázquez and other Old Masters, Manet sought acceptance despite repeated rejections from the Paris Salon. In 1863, he exhibited a painting at the Salon des Refusés, an alternative exhibition for art excluded by the Salon. Featuring a naked woman between two clothed men, the work scandalized the public, but inspired several young artists who later became the Impressionists. Although Manet never exhibited with them, they became close friends and they saw him as their unofficial leader.



Manet, *A Bar at the Folies-Bergère*, 1881–2